

SELIN OZDAMAR

PhD Candidate in Economics

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Health Economics · Public Finance · Inclusive Growth · Inequality and Poverty · Macroeconomic Shocks · Panel Data Econometrics

ABOUT

My research sits at the intersection of health economics, public finance, and inclusive growth, with a focus on producing policy-relevant empirical evidence. Between 2021 and 2024, I worked full-time in digital marketing analytics before returning to my doctoral studies, an experience that deepened my applied data skills and broadened my perspective on evidence-based decision-making.

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics	2020 – Present
<i>Lisbon School of Economics and Management (ISEG), Universidade de Lisboa, Portugal</i>	
Supervisor: Prof. João Jalles	
Dissertation: Inclusive Growth and Health Expenditures	
2025 FCT Doctoral Scholarship	
MSc in Economics and Political Science	2017 – 2020
<i>Università degli Studi di Milano, Italy</i>	
Supervisor: Prof. Michele Santoni	
Co-supervisor: Prof. Fabrizio Iacone	
University of Milan funding (2017–2020)	
BSc in International Relations	2012 – 2016
<i>Kadir Has University, Istanbul, Turkey</i>	
Erasmus Exchange, University of Coimbra, Portugal (2014)	

RESEARCH

PhD Dissertation Essays

- “Public versus Private Health Spending in the Growth-Inequality-Poverty Nexus”
Working paper: [REM WP 0411/2026](#) · SSRN: [abstract_id=6581098](#)
- “Pandemics, Inequality, and the Public Health Expenditure Buffer: Evidence from Five Epidemics and COVID-19”
Working paper: [REM WP 0412/2026](#) · SSRN: [abstract_id=6589332](#)
- “Out-of-Pocket Health Spending and Income Inequality in the United States: Threshold Effects and Structural Change”

Master’s Dissertation

- “Military Expenditure and Economic Growth in the United States 1947–2018: An Empirical Analysis”
Available on request at the [Università degli Studi di Milano repository \(Minerva\)](#)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS / ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

4th CINCH-dggö Academy in Health Economics, University of Duisburg-Essen, Germany	2026
International Conference on Empirical Economics (ICEE, PSU Altoona), Online	2026
14th UECE Conference on Economic and Financial Adjustments, ISEG, Lisbon	2026
10th International PhD Meeting in Economics, University of Macedonia, Thessaloniki	2026
13th UECE Conference on Economic and Financial Adjustments, Lisbon	2025
EB-UMA, IV International PhD Student Conference in Economics, Business and Sociology	2025
12th UECE Conference on Economic and Financial Adjustments, Lisbon	2024
International Neighborhood Symposium, Heybeliada, Turkey	2015
Associate Director of Public Relations, HASMUN, Kadir Has University	2013
YGA Conference	2012

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Marketing Analyst

Oct 2021 – Jun 2024

Cognizant Technology Solutions, Lisbon, Portugal

- Designed and optimised high-value advertising campaigns across Google Search, GSN, Mobile, and YouTube, improving ROI through keyword analysis, bid strategies, and budget optimisation.
- Gathered and analysed account- and campaign-level data to identify performance trends and actionable opportunities.
- Developed detailed reports and dashboards for optimisation strategies and stakeholder decision-making.

Platform Experience Associate

Mar 2021 – Oct 2021

Accenture Portugal, Lisbon, Portugal

- Executed data entry, cleansing, and research tasks across multiple platforms and tracking tools.
- Generated regular status updates and facilitated cross-functional team communication.

Intern

Nov 2019 – Dec 2019

Consulate of Turkey, Milan, Italy

- Managed documentation workflows; enhanced administrative reporting processes.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Statistical Software	Stata (advanced), R (beginner), SQL (beginner)
Econometric Methods	3SLS, GMM, Local Projections, Panel Data, Fixed Effects, VAR, SVAR, Panel VAR, ARDL
Productivity	Microsoft Excel, Word, PowerPoint; LaTeX; Google Ads

LANGUAGES

Turkish	Native
English	C1 (IELTS B2+)
Italian	A2–B1
Portuguese	A2 (CIPLE)

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

Google Ads Certified	Google
SQL Fundamentals	Datacamp
Composite Indicators course	Centerstat and Coursera